

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6 4

♥ K 7 4

♦ 10 7 3

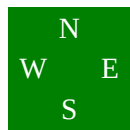
♣ Q J 3

♠ A Q J 10

♥ A 6 5

♦ A Q 8 5

♣ K 10



♠ 7 5 3

♥ Q 3

♦ K J 6 2

♣ 8 5 4 2

♠ 9 2

♥ J 10 9 8 2

♦ 9 4

♣ A 9 7 6

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

entries. Your obvious entries are the ♦ K and ♦ J. If West holds only two small ♠s with his ♠ K, then two entries will be enough. But what if West holds ♠ K x x x ? Can you find a third entry to dummy?

If the ♦s split 3-2 the answer is **YES**. Play the ♦ A, then lead your ♦ 8 to dummy's ♦ J. Watch carefully to see if both defenders follow to this trick. They do. Play a ♠ to your ♠ 10, which holds the trick. Play your ♦ Q to dummy's ♦ K. Finesse the ♠ again. Return to dummy by playing your ♦ 5 to dummy's ♦ 6, then finesse the ♠ one last time.

If the ♦s had split 4-1 you would not have been able to enter dummy three times. That would have been very unlucky.

If you played your ♦ 5 too early you would not have been able to enter dummy three times even when there was a 3-2 split. That would have been very unsmart.

With 20 HCP and balanced distribution you should open 2NT. Do not let the good 4-card ♠ suit sway you to anything else. Partner bids 3NT and everybody passes.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥ J. You try the ♥ Q, but West plays the ♥ K.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 4 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

You need 3 more winners and at least 2 of them must come from ♠s. Furthermore you don't want West to lead ♣s through your King. Your best hope is that West holds the ♠ K so you can finesse.

So you win the ♥ A and start thinking about dummy entries. Your obvious entries are the ♦ K and ♦ J. If West holds only two small ♠s with his ♠ K, then two entries will be enough. But what if West holds ♠ K x x x ? Can you find a third entry to dummy?

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 5 4 2

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K 8 5

♣ 8 3

♠ K J 3

♥ J 8 3

♦ 7 4

♣ J 10 9 5 4



♠ 7 6

♥ K 10 7

♦ Q J 6 2

♣ Q 7 6 2

♠ A Q 9

♥ A 6 4 2

♦ A 10 9 3

♣ A K

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

2NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Those two entries can only be the ♠K and ♠J. So you absolutely **MUST** win the first trick in your hand with the ♠A. Then play the ♣ A K. Over to dummy by playing ♠9 to ♠J. Lead the ♣J to drive out the ♣Q. Win whatever they return and play ♠Q to ♠K to reach your two good ♣s.

When you need dummy entries you may need to win a trick in your hand with an unnecessarily high card - like in this case.

You can only win 3 ♠ tricks however you play it, so you play to suit your entry needs.

You have 6 HCP and a 5-card suit. Although you can't be sure, there is a good chance your hand will be useful to partner.

So you bid 3NT.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠4. You play dummy's ♠3 and East contributes the ♠6.

You can get them in ♣s, but only if you are careful.

After you unblock the ♣ A K you will go to dummy and play the ♣J. Then, after the ♣Q is driven out you will return to dummy for the two ♣ winners. That means you need **TWO** dummy entries.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 3
♥ J 9 8
♦ Q 10 7 2
♣ K 7 5

♠ A J 5

♥ A 6 3

♦ A K 6

♣ J 10 9 2



♠ K 10 8 6 2

♥ Q 10 4

♦ J 8 4 3

♣ 6

♠ 7 4

♥ K 7 5 2

♦ 9 5

♣ A Q 8 4 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
at trick one. Do you win or hold up?

You should assume that East holds the ♠K.

If you take the ♠A right now your ♠J 5 will provide a second stopper if it is East who gets the lead. However, if West gets the lead he will play through your holding and you may lose 4 ♠ tricks.

If you hold up you can expect West to play another ♠ through your ♠A J and East will then establish the suit. However, in doing so he will remove any ♠ held by West.

The answer key lies in the ♣ suit. You will be finessing through East, so West is the only defender who can get the lead in ♣s. Therefore you must hold up on ♠s until the third round.

If you win the first ♠ West will play a ♠ through your ♠J 5 when he wins the ♣K. East will then swamp you with ♠s.

But, if you hold up your ♠A until the third round, West will have no ♠ left when he wins the ♣K.

With no 4-card Major suit you respond 2♦ to partner's Stayman bid. Partner now bids 2NT.

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With a full 17 points you accept partner's game invitation and bid 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠6 on which West plays the ♠Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

You need 3 more tricks, obviously coming from the ♣ suit.

But the burning question right now is what do you do